

Level Up

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(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- (b) Consumption is always social even when it addresses physical needs.
Elaborate. (15 marks)

Consumption refers to the intake of materials needed to fulfil certain requirements

eg - food consumption to regulate metabolic activities

- using clothes to withstand extreme climate

Consumption patterns are shaped by several social factors even though their role is fulfilled of same needs

eg - All humans eat food but consumption practices vary over time and space

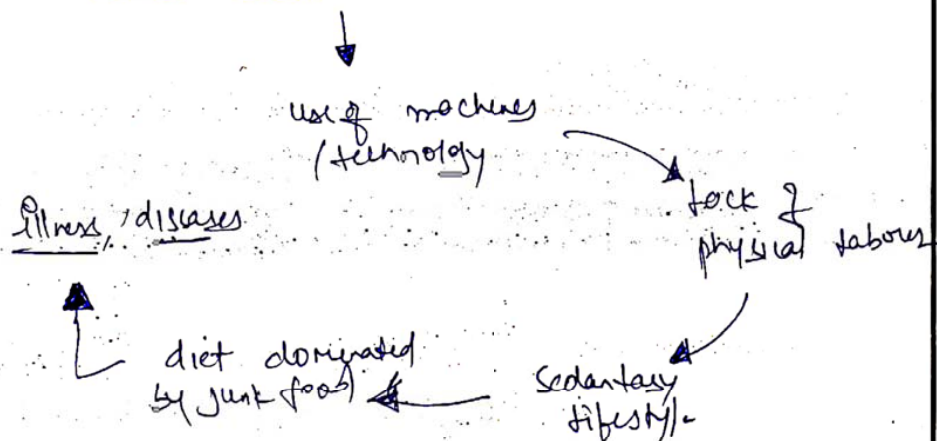
CASE STUDY

Robert Carneiro studied Bushmen hunting and noted that they had an elaborate set of rules with respect to distribution of different parts of hunt to different kin groups.

He highlighted the consumption, though satisfies biological needs, is embedded in social matrix.

Consumption pattern in different societies

- (i) Hunter gathering → eat cooked meat
- (ii) Pastoralists → diet is a combination of animal and plant products
eg Teda (Nilgiri)
- (iii) Swiddening societies → are nomadic and produce subsistence agriculture crops
- (iv) Modern societies → variety of choices.



Thus, consumption is decided by social conditions.